the SWITZER FAMILY
serving in South Africa

June/July 2021

Dear Partners in the Gospel,

Nelson Fen grew up in church. Around the time of his birth, missionaries Jeff and Judy Blanton came to Upington and established the Bible Baptist Church of Paballelo. Until the church building was constructed, the church assembled under a tent in the backyard of Nelson's parents' home. Nelson was exposed to the clear Gospel of Jesus Christ from the time that he could understand. While Nelson was a teenager, his father was ordained as the pastor of Bible Baptist Church when the Blantons transitioned to another church plant. However, in spite of his exposure to the Gospel and in spite of growing up in a Godly home, Nelson never personally received Jesus Christ as his Savior.

Through the following years, Nelson entered adulthood and began making his own way through life. Nelson did not get into some of the trouble that others did, but he did not live with the fear of the Lord as his instructor in the way of wisdom either. His father pastored the Bible Baptist Church until his death in 2015, and both his mother and older brother remain members of the church. Yet, Nelson himself has been content with his life as it is without Christ.

We met Nelson when we came to Upington in 2016. Nelson is a friendly and easy-going man now in his late-30s. Over the past few years, Nelson has attended the church services when he is not working weekends at the police department. When he comes, he is probably our best singer during congregational singing and one of the best listeners during the preaching. However, he continues to be without Christ.

From the testimony of those who know him, Nelson is firm in his understanding that salvation is through faith in Christ alone—even saying so to his co-workers during religious discussions. However, Nelson has yet to personally take the truth he understands and appropriate it to himself through humbling himself to call upon Christ for his own salvation.

In November 2020, Nelson married his wife, **Zurita**, who grew up in the Apostolic church. According to cultural norms, when a couple is married, the wife must join her new husband at the church of which he is a part. Even though Nelson has never received Christ and (obviously) has never been baptized nor joined the church, Nelson considers Bible Baptist Church to be his church. Thus, since their wedding, both Nelson and Zurita attend our services whenever they can.

Nelson and Zurita are a sweet couple, and Zurita is a kind lady. Zurita will often come to church even if Nelson must work. She listens very intently to the preaching, and we have been able to begin a developing relationship with her. Zurita has been increasing in her understanding of the Gospel; however, neither Nelson nor Zurita have yet received salvation.

Praise be to our wonderful God Who continues to be longsuffering to sinners yet in need of repentance and extends to them mercy so that they might repent and believe the Gospel! We do not know if Nelson and Zurita will eventually receive Christ, but we know that our Father loves them and is providing them opportunities to be confronted with the Gospel, we know that Christ is sufficient to save them, and we know that the Spirit of God continues to work through the Word of God to convince them of the truth of the Gospel.

Please pray for Nelson and Zurita Fen to be good ground for the Gospel, and please pray for us to have wisdom, opportunities, and boldness to share Christ with them.

At the end of June, South Africa was returned to a Level 4 COVID lockdown, which is the second highest lockdown level. As part of the lockdown, all assemblies of any type, including religious assemblies, were forbidden. Thus, we were unable to have in person services for four Sundays. We are thankful for the lockdown being lessened to Level 3 towards the end of July. Our in-person services resumed on August 1.

In connection with our previous letter, we do thank you for continuing to pray for the **children's Bible class.** We resumed the class on August 8 and saw our highest attendance yet of 28 young people! Praise the Lord for His continued work regardless of the circumstances in the world!

Thank you for your faithful love, prayers, and support as we partner together in the work of the Gospel.

In His Service,
Jonathan, Katie, Jeremiah, Isaiah, and Alaythia Switzer

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